

00 A CONCEPT, EXPLAINED —

# Essential complexity.

On the model that outlives the tools — from business architecture to code.

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# From business architecture to code — end-to-end traceability.

Four areas shaped my career: software development, methodology, IT architecture and business architecture. I know all four.

The goal is always end-to-end continuity — from the business domain to implementation. Only the path there was long expensive and hard.

# A model captures a problem in its essential complexity — no more.

Capture the essential, leave out the unimportant. That is the real craft.

My standard for every model, for about 15 years.

## BEFORE

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### UML · SysML · your own DSL

Powerful — but hard, specialized, expensive. Few can read it.

**Same precision — far less friction.**

## TODAY

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### AI understands natural language.

With the right meta-model: the facts as Markdown — cheap to create and maintain, readable for everyone.

# The Mental Model.

A structured knowledge base — I call it the Mental Model.

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## Domains & terms

Booking · Finance · Door Access · Task

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## How we work

Roles · teams · processes with gates

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## Why this way

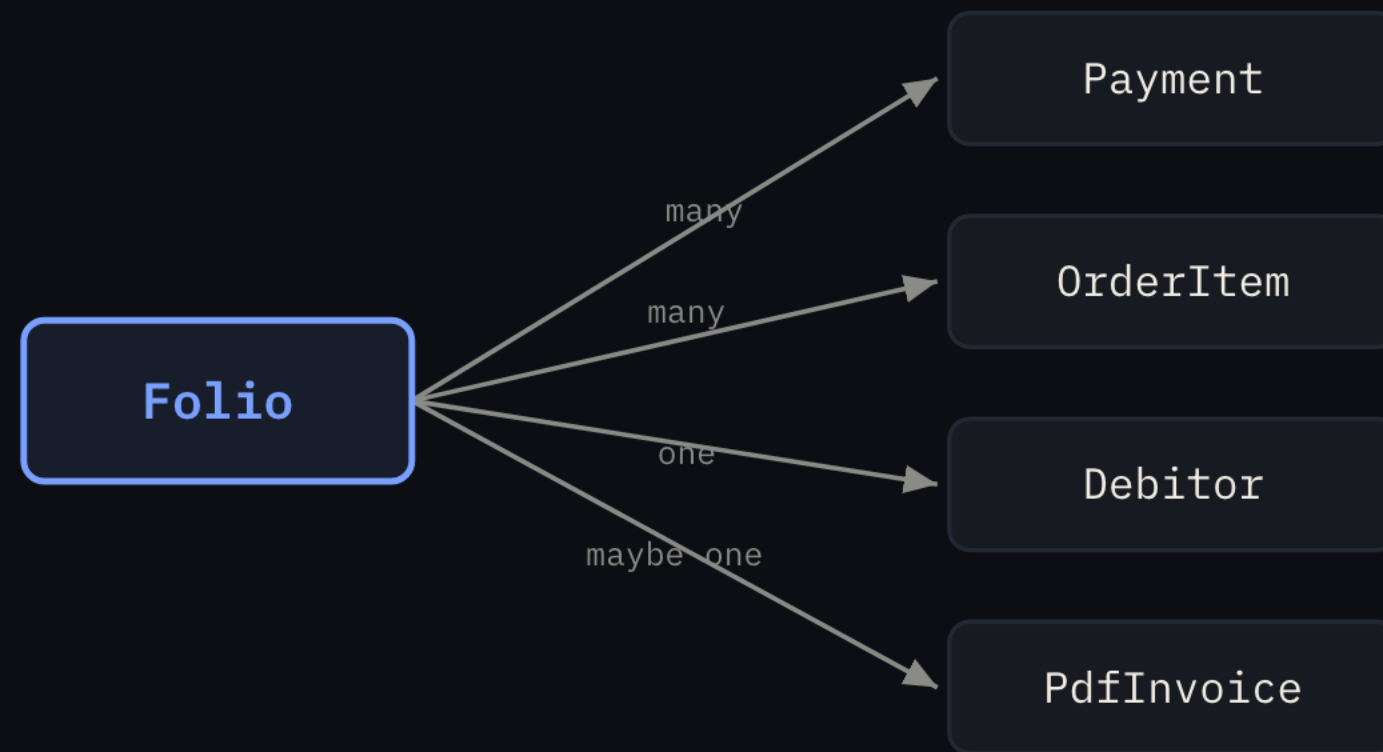
Architecture decisions · rules

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## How we measure

KPIs

Facts as Markdown · structured by a meta-model · **machine-readable**



### **Folio**

Financial account of a reservation — bundles all line items of a stay.

### **OrderItem**

A single line item on the folio.

### **Payment**

Payment that settles order items fully or partly.

### **Debitor**

Who owes the bill — person or company.

### **PdfInvoice**

The finalized invoice at check-out.

Real model from LIKE MAGIC – **Markdown + Mermaid**

Every term in one sentence – **no more, no less.**

# One model that **everything** can be measured against.

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- ✓ **Requirements** use only terms from the **glossary** — one language, no synonyms.
  - ✓ **Implementation** validated against **glossary + ADRs**.
  - ✓ **New terms** must land in the **glossary** first — otherwise no merge.
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Not documentation but an artifact to validate against — so that **change gets cheaper and safer**.

# The right context makes AI far more reliable.

A model like the Mental Model gives AI the right context: it does not eliminate hallucinations — but it shrinks the space where AI has to guess, moving it from guessing to grounded reasoning. The cleaner the structure, the better the context. In practice: the Mental Model as a context layer for AI assistants.

# The pendulum swings — back to spec-driven development.

From “no big design up front” to spec-first — because AI makes specifications fast and affordable.

For years upfront modeling was too expensive, so agile deliberately dropped it. That math has changed.

# Tools come and go — the model stays.

The standard stays: capture essential complexity. Only now the path is open to everyone.

That is how I still build today: close to the code, but with the model in mind.  
Thank you.